

Normative Sample of the PEAK Relational Training System: Generalization Module with Comparison to Individuals with Autism

Mark R. Dixon¹ · Kyle E. Rowsey¹ · Karl F. Gunnarsson¹ ·
Jordan Belisle¹ · Caleb R. Stanley¹ · Jacob H. Daar¹

Published online: 5 December 2016
© Springer Science+Business Media New York 2016

Abstract With the rising number of individuals diagnosed with autism and other developmental disabilities comes an increased need for effective assessment and treatment options. Previous research has indicated that applied behavior analytic techniques are among the most empirically supported and utilized treatments for this population; however, curriculum and assessment tools rooted in utilizing these techniques have very little empirical support for their reliability and validity. The current studies sought to assess the performance of both a normative sample and a sample with autism on one such assessment tool: The PEAK Generalization Module. Altogether, 183 typically developing children participated in study 1 and 84 children with a diagnosis of autism participated in study 2. The results indicated that the normative sample demonstrated a strong positive correlation between the PEAK Generalization Assessment and age, whereas the sample with autism demonstrated no significant relationship between the two. Further analysis indicates that the PEAK Generalization Assessment may be an appropriate tool for assessing

✉ Mark R. Dixon
MDixon@siu.edu

Kyle E. Rowsey
Rowsey27@siu.edu

Karl F. Gunnarsson
Karl@siu.edu

Jordan Belisle
JBelisle@siu.edu

Caleb R. Stanley
Calebrstanley@siu.edu

Jacob H. Daar
Jdaar@siu.edu

¹ Behavior Analysis and Therapy Program, Rehabilitation Institute, Southern Illinois University, Carbondale, IL 62901, USA